THE PUSHBACK PLAYBOOK

Acknowledge → **Clarify** → **Hold the line** → **Redirect**

They say	Hold this line	Sample response
"The data's wrong / biased."	Facts about who responded. No validation claims, no caving.	*"Fair question. [N] of [invited] responded, across every group. Here's what that means for how much weight it carries…"*
"Who said that?"	Anonymity is absolute.	*"I don't know, and wouldn't share it if I did. It came up [several] times. Here's how you can act on it…"*
"Which team is the problem?"	Patterns, not culprits. Only groups the report shows.	*"It's a pattern, not a team. It's lowest where [X] and [Y] meet…"*
"What's the benchmark? What's good?"	It's the Mosaic benchmark, not "the industry". There's no pass mark.	*"Compared with organizations in the Mosaic benchmark you're at the [n]th percentile. Whether that's enough depends on what you're trying to do…"*
"Fix it by next quarter."	Culture moves slowly. Use the right tool and timing.	*"Let's act now and run a progress check on the 1–3 priorities in 6–9 months. Meanwhile, here are early signals to watch…"*
(360) "A couple of people skewed this."	Rater confidentiality. N corrects the belief.	*"[n] of [n] responded, so it's not a couple of voices. What might they be experiencing?"*
"Can you lower the threshold so we can see [small group]?"	Never lower a threshold to expose a group.	*"Those groups are combined to protect the people in them. That's a promise we made, and we keep it."*
"So the programme failed?" (no meaningful change)	No meaningful change ≠ failure.	*"We can't see a change yet. That could mean no effect, too soon, or too small to detect. Here's how we'll find out…"*